

## **Em's Notes**

(Note to Laufey: May be Disorganized)

### **Potential Client: Center of Student Affairs (CSA) - Mentoring Unit**

- Originally the Office of Guidance and Mentoring Council (under the CSA)
  - The university has since split the unit into two: Office of Guidance and Counseling and Mentoring (They are still under the CSA)
    - Counseling handles mental health
    - Mentoring handles holistic formation
- List of professors is provided by the different schools (Not 100% sure based on handwritten notes)
  - The unit receives them and approves which one are eligible for mentorship
  - Gives the schools the list of approved mentors
- Mechanism for monitoring Mentoring Sessions (current)
  - Students log their session using a Google Forms
  - Upon answering the form, an email will be automatically generated (Google Script) and sent to the corresponding mentor
  - The mentor responds to the email, confirming the session details
  - Confirmation is sent to the Google Forms responses sheet (Google Sheets) and updates the corresponding row
  - NOTE: This new process was recently implemented at the start of AY 2026-27
- Mentor count
  - Professors - about 180
    - Each Prof can have a varying number of students assigned to them
  - External Mentors (from outside the school) - dependent on who is available
    - Not all external mentors are available, but have agreed to mentor
- Mentoring Unit reports to the Executive Director
  - The Exec reports to Mancomm
  - She also coordinates with the other different schools' opcoms
- Mentoring Unit is composed of only 2 employees
- Schools
  - Each has a varied number of mentoring coordinators
    - These coordinate with the Mentoring Unit
    - Finance Office coordinates with their pay

- HR handles the external mentors
- Mentoring Unit coordinates with the IT Office
  - Originally, the Mentoring Unit used a mentoring session reporting portal (designed by the IT department)
    - Mentor logs in the session details
    - However, the mentor forgets to log them
    - NOTE: Our Solution Architecture Professor was the one who designed and developed this portal
      - This project is a double-edge sword!
  - Now, the IT Dept created a new Google Form and reporting procedure
    - Instead of the mentor logging it, the responsibility has shifted to the student
- On approving changes/policies:
  - All of these are at the Executive Director's level
  - She checks if they follow the University's own institutional policies
  - If drastic changes/policies, she requests approval from Mancomm
- There is only one Mentoring Unit program. They handle:
  - Junior College
  - Undergraduates (4YP, 6YP)
  - Graduate Programs
    - Students under this program are encouraged (not required) to do mentoring
    - All other students are required
- Mentee-Mentor Matching
  - Each school's mentoring coordinator matches the students to a mentor
  - Matching criteria:
    - Mentor's teaching subject/skill matches the student's course
    - And/Or, based on familiarity
  - The schools inform the unit of the matching
- Change of Mentor when the student requests it (reasons):
  - No connection, no rapport, or they found somebody better
  - Mentor already resigned/left the University
  - No relationship was established
- Information the GForm requests (just check the actual GForm)

- Generic information
- Session Duration
- Date
- Questions asking if the session met the goals set
  - These are asked to improve the program/sessions
- Consequences of students not meeting the required 3 mentoring sessions a semester
  - Their status will be set to “follow up”
    - They will automatically get scheduled one by the end of the semester
  - If they fail to meet the quota in 2 consecutive semesters, it will affect their eligibility to enroll in the following semester
- Unit's Frustrations
  - Ensuring the mentor, student, and mentoring sessions databases (they're Google Sheets) are complete
    - 1800 students + 180 mentors
  - Though not a frustrations, there may have been undocumented loggings in the past and the possibility in this new policy
- School contacts (Mentoring Coordinators)
  - SSE
    - Dr. Olmos, Dra. Noyomi
  - SED
    - Dr. Lactao
  - And other schools. . .
- Database of Student-Mentor Paring contain:
  - Name
  - Student ID
  - Program
  - Yr Level
    - This is constantly checking with the registrar
    - This is just a manual process
  - Email
  - Mentor
  - Mentor's Email
- There is only one student-mentor pairing database
  - The GForms response is separate

- On the Sessions logging GForms:
  - Upon the mentor confirming the session, another email is sent to the admin
    - This is done for Admin proofing and backup of responses
    - This is a dedicated email for the responses
- Delays: Just Pairings
  - Schools only do if they have the complete enrollment list from the registrar
    - This changes from time to time
    - And they are also busy doing other stuff
  - It also depends on the school
    - Each has their own pairing process
    - Different coordinators and different volume of students per school
  - It takes about a 1 week or 2 to finish the pairing on average
- On changing the mentor
  - It takes too many emails
  - Steps for changing mentor:
    - Student emails or speaks in-person to the unit of their request
    - Unit then talks to the current mentor informing them of the request
    - Then talk to the new mentor
    - Then talk to the school (coordinator)
  - Each person/group must approve of the change
    - Talking usually involves emails
    - The school has the final say on the change of mentor
- Mentor-pairing must be finished by the start of the semester
  - They are proposing to have the pairing for the upperclassment done by the end of the school years
- On making fixes by us:
  - They are open
  - Note from self: everything seems to be enrollment dependent
- Other fixes they tried to do:
  - Tried to approve the pairing list ahead of time without the official mentor list
  - Freshmen + JC mentor pairing — done by the unit personally then forwarded to the school
    - I forgot if this was a proposal or an actual fix they tried to do

- Everything they are doing for this year is new (first time for everything and they don't know if it will be effective)
- Look of success
  - All students are able to attend mentoring
  - All students can define what mentoring is through their experience
  - All students can establish good relationship with their mentors
  - Students are no longer required to log their sessions (well shet)
- What they want:
  - Pairing and monitoring only (Admin scope)
    - IDK what I wrote here
  - Students can see a short profile of the mentor
  - Get the perspective of the students on what services the unit can provide
    - Expand the program to the students
    - Make students do group mentoring
- On student data
  - Data integrity across all different processes
    - Who is paired to (mentor + school)
- On university policy
  - Everything is confidential
  - Data privacy reasons
    - Change of mentor is very personal!
- Approval times of different projects/policies/changes:
  - Center of Student Affairs (CSA) - takes about 2 weeks
  - Mancomm - varies
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